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On Top at Last, Knicks and City Enjoy the View

By EMMA GOLDBERG

You could call it a parade. But really it was a jubilee, rapture, pure silliness, a weepy rebirth for the thousands of New Yorkers who needed a reason to believe and found it in their hometown team.

A dialysis technician from Brownsville, Brooklyn, watched the sun rise over Lower Manhattan, basking in the eerie hush before the festivities erupted. A doorman on Wall Street took the overnight shift so he could secure his spot on the parade route, sporting orange and blue socks under his uniform. A dentist from Long Island stood on Broadway at 6 a.m. wearing an orange-and-blue turban wrapped by his wife, who said she'd waited her whole life for this one day. The film star John Turturro got choked up thinking of Knicks fans who had died before seeing this win.

Never before has New York City had a championship parade for the Knicks. Lower Manhattan's so-called Canyon of Heroes has turned upside down in celebration before — for the Yankees and for the Giants, for the Liberty and for Winston Churchill, for Nelson Mandela and for the men who walked on the moon. But when the Knicks won their previous championships, more than half a century ago, the city skipped the parades and held more modest celebrations.

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Fans packed the streets of Lower Manhattan on Thursday as the Knicks, including Jalen Brunson, top left, the N.B.A. finals M.V.P., rode in a parade through the Canyon of Heroes. The Knicks' first title in 53 years was greeted with 2,500 pounds of confetti and some quintessentially New York signs, including one that read, "My therapist told me this day would come." More in Sports, Section D.

Ukraine Hits Moscow With One of Biggest Drone Attacks of War

By PAUL SONNE and NATALIYA VASILYEVA

BERLIN — Black smoke from a burning oil refinery filled the Moscow sky. The city's four airports were urgently closed. And part of the busy highway that rings the Russian capital, a metropolis of 13 million people, was shut down.

As Ukraine escalated its effort to bring the war home for Russians, the strikes on Thursday appeared to be the largest drone attack on the Russian capital since President Vladimir V. Putin launched the war more than four years ago.

No deaths were immediately reported. But the large-scale assault seemed likely to feed fears among Russians that the Kremlin's abil-

ity to isolate society from the effects of the war was sharply eroding. That would usher in a new stage for a conflict that has now run longer than World War I.

For days, lines have formed and rationing has been implemented at gas stations in dozens of Russian regions, as persistent Ukrainian drone attacks on oil refineries and processing facilities have threatened a fuel shortage.

Ukraine has taken particular aim at Crimea, the peninsula that Russia illegally annexed in 2014, with a range of strikes aimed at cutting off the region's supply lines. The Russian economy has also begun suffering from the costs of the war in a way that the Kremlin had managed to avoid for years.

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AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

Ukrainian attacks on oil refineries and processing plants, like the Gazprom facility in Moscow, have threatened a fuel shortage.

Vance Admonishes Israel For Criticism of Iran Deal

NEWS ANALYSIS

Seeking a Surrender, Getting Much Less

By DAVID E. SANGER

WASHINGTON — It was less than 15 weeks ago when President Trump, at the height of his bravado about how the war with Iran would end, declared "there will be no deal with Iran except UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER."

When the text of the deal intended to wind down the conflict was finally released on Wednesday, read aloud paragraph by paragraph by a senior administration official who stopped to defend each section, it read nothing like a surrender document. Instead, the Iranians emerged from a confrontation with the world's most powerful military having not only survived, but with much to celebrate.

It starts with the resumption of Tehran's ability to reap billions of dollars in oil sales, lifting pressure on the struggling regime even as negotiators prepare to begin haggling over a far more lengthy and critical document: the one Mr. Trump insisted in an interview on Sunday will arrest Iran's nuclear program for the next 15 or 20 years.

For a president who prizes leverage above all else, that decision is just another mystery of the war. But the wording of the "Memorandum of Understanding" also suggests that, over time, Iran may negotiate some permanent way to exercise sovereignty over the Strait of Hormuz. That seems in contradiction to Secretary of State Marco Rubio's declarations just a few weeks ago that anything other than the kind of free passage through the strait that the world knew before the war was "not acceptable" and "cannot happen."

And the memorandum, signed on Wednesday evening by Iran's president and Mr. Trump, describes a pathway in which Iran could begin receiving billions of dollars in assets that have been frozen for years. Mr. Trump insists the money will be released only in return for "good behavior." But it is essentially the same concession that Barack Obama made 11 years ago, and that Mr. Trump has savaged ever since.

As Mr. Trump reminds reporters — often angrily — the United States did have many accomplishments on the battlefield: It sank Iran's less-than-impressive navy, wiped out its small air force, destroyed much of Iran's defense industrial base and demolished some of its missile emplacements and mobile launchers. But that was not Mr. Trump's goal. As he said at the opening of the campaign, he

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Warning Nation Not to Alienate Most Powerful Ally

This article is by Jonathan Swan, Erica L. Green, Max Bearak and Michael Levenson.

WASHINGTON — Vice President JD Vance delivered an extraordinary rebuke on Thursday to Israeli officials who had disparaged the U.S.-Iran deal as he began a campaign promoting the agreement in the face of criticism in Israel and Washington.

Speaking to reporters at the White House, Mr. Vance said he had a message for members of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's cabinet who had denounced the deal and had "very personally attacked" President Trump.

"Donald J. Trump is the only head of state in the entire world who is sympathetic to the nation



ALLISON ROBERT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Vice President JD Vance is seeking support for the pact.

of Israel at this moment in time, and he happens to be the head of state of the world's superpower," Mr. Vance said. "If I was in the cabinet of the Israeli government, I might not be attacking the only powerful ally that I have anywhere left in the entire world."

Mr. Vance said he wanted to remind the Israelis that two-thirds of the weapons that "protected your homeland" were American-made and paid for by U.S. tax dollars.

His blunt message — effectively telling the Israelis that they have been diplomatically isolated and have Americans paying for their defense — was the latest sign of tensions between Mr. Trump and Mr. Netanyahu, just over three months after they launched a joint bombing campaign against Iran.

Israel is not a party to the deal to end the war, and its fighting with Hezbollah, the Iranian-backed militia in Lebanon, had threatened to derail the U.S.-Iran talks, to the frustration of American officials. Mr. Vance's remarks came a day after Mr. Trump admonished Mr. Netanyahu over the Israeli military onslaught in Lebanon.

Mr. Vance also pushed back on

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Justices Rule Gun Law Allows Leeway for Casual Drug Users

By ABBIE VANSICKLE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Thursday narrowed a federal gun control measure, siding with a marijuana user who had challenged a provision that had banned drug users from owning or possessing guns.

The justices ruled that the government's use of the law was overbroad, sweeping together recreational drug users with people addicted to drugs who posed a danger to public safety.

Justice Neil M. Gorsuch wrote the decision. All of the justices agreed with the outcome, although several wrote separately to explain their decision-making.

"We appreciate that drugs and gun can sometimes make for a dangerous mix," Justice Gorsuch wrote. However, he wrote, the justices rejected the government's "expansive theory" in the case and found that a historical analogy the government advanced to laws barring habitual drunkards from owning guns "fails under every measure it asks us to consider."

The case, U.S. v. Hemani, was one of two major gun rights cases to come before the Supreme Court this term, providing opportunities for the court to clarify how to ap-

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Slow Count Invites Suspicion

California's crawling pace after election night can make normal statistical shifts seem like fraud. PAGE A12

Obama Center Opens in Style

A star-studded lineup included four former presidents, Bruce Springsteen and Jennifer Hudson. PAGE A17



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Taliban Ban on Smartphones

Afghanistan ordered all civil servants and members of the country's armed forces to stop bringing their devices to work, or face punishment. PAGE A6

U.S. Scales Back Disease Work

The State Department will run many global health programs and overhaul the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's H.I.V. initiative. PAGE A10

A Wider Path to Citizenship

People who can prove a direct Canadian-born ancestor can become a citizen of the country after a legal decision last year. Requests are flooding in. PAGE A7

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Redirecting Wealth to China

Eager to keep capital within its borders, Beijing is stressing geopolitical issues and restricting the ways its people can engage with global markets. PAGE B1

Fewer Signals From the Fed

Investors piled on bets for higher borrowing costs after the central bank's chairman, Kevin M. Warsh, opted not to give policy guidance. PAGE B1

A SpaceX and Tesla Merger?

Although the two companies have long shared resources, some shareholders might object but there is little they could do, legal experts say. PAGE B1

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Tablets in Toyland

In "Toy Story 5," Buzz Lightyear and the rest of the gang must contend with a mesmerizing plaything. PAGE C1

Giacometti's Entourage

The Met's Temple of Dendur has been reanimated with sculptures. Below, behind the Sphinx, a bronze cat. PAGE C1



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The Star U.S. Soccer Needed

Folarin Balogun is living out the World Cup dream he and the national team had hoped he would. PAGE D9

U.F.C. Star Defends Treatment

Conor McGregor, about his path back from injury that included banned drugs, said his goal was to walk again. PAGE D8

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